

Bivalves

A bivalve's shell has two parts joined by a hinge. If danger strikes, most bivalves close their shells, sealing themselves inside. Bivalves always live in water, except seashore ones exposed at low tide. Also known as clams, most of them are filter-feeders, although giant clams get some of their food from microscopic algae, which live in their multicolored lips.



The giant clams of coral reefs can grow up to 4 ft (1.2 m) across.



Cockles are saltwater clams that burrow into sediment on muddy shores, using a muscular foot.



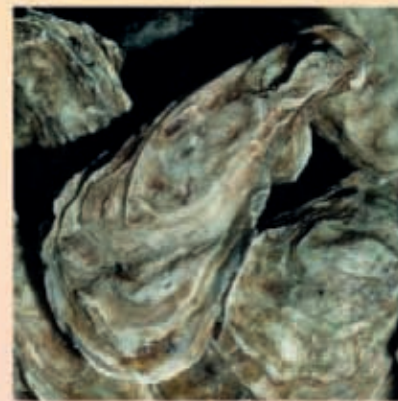
Scallops clap their shells together to swim. They have two rows of eyes along the shell opening.



Razor clams have long, slender, rectangular shells and can dig rapidly into sand and mud.



Mussels attach themselves permanently to rocks with tough elastic threads.



Oysters live in estuaries and lagoons, where they stay permanently in oyster beds on the mud.

Cephalopods

Fast-moving and intelligent predators, cephalopods have arms with suckers and can swim by squirting a jet of water, although squid and cuttlefish also ripple their fins. Nautilus has a spiral shell, but other cephalopods have an internal shell, or no shell at all. They live in the sea, sometimes at great depths.



Living in open water, squid include giant species more than 33 ft (10 m) long. Some use body language to communicate threat.



Cuttlefish are experts at color change. They shoot out two long tentacles to catch their prey.



Nautilus has up to 90 short tentacles and a shell with gas-filled chambers that keep it afloat.

Octopuses' bulbous heads contain large brains and beaklike jaws. Their eight arms are connected by webs of skin. Some use these webs to sail on currents near the seabed.